CHANDRASHEKAR BALA

Cybersecurity Professional | Penetration Testing | Security Research

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Summary

Cybersecurity professional specializing in penetration testing, vulnerability assessment, and web application security. Expert in using Nmap, Burp Suite, and Wireshark to identify and validate security weaknesses, delivering actionable remediation. Successfully documented **8 findings** in a web application assessment, enhanced Linux wireless drivers by modifying **13 source files**, and completed **50+ PortSwigger labs** to sharpen practical skills.

Skills

Reconnaissance and Network Security: Nmap, Nmap Scripting Engine (NSE), host discovery, TCP/UDP port scanning, service/version enumeration, service fingerprinting, DNS, TCP/IP, UDP, DHCP, subnetting, exposed-service validation

Web Application Penetration Testing: Burp Suite, OWASP Top 10, HTTP/HTTPS request and response analysis, SQL injection testing, authentication and access-control testing, cookie/session inspection, directory and backup-file exposure, information disclosure, evidence capture

Network Traffic and Wireless Analysis: Wireshark, packet capture, protocol analysis, Aircrack-ng, wireless adapter diagnostics, RTL8812BU/RTL8822BU driver investigation, Linux module loading

Vulnerability Assessment and Exploitation: Vulnerability discovery and validation, severity assessment, exploitability review, Metasploit, evidence-based reporting, remediation recommendations, retesting

Reverse Engineering and Forensics: Ghidra, GDB, C source analysis, binary inspection, debugging, Windows registry and filesystem artefacts, Volatility, suspicious-file investigation

Threat Intelligence and Research: OSINT, threat-report analysis, IOC research, MITRE ATT&CK, adversary research, forensic evidence review

Programming and Systems: Python, Bash, C, SQL, Linux, Kali Linux, Windows, Git, GCC, Linux kernel headers, shell scripting, build and module troubleshooting

Security Operations and Tooling: Google Chronicle, log analysis, alert triage, security monitoring, incident-response workflows, vulnerability prioritisation, technical documentation

Professional Experience

Team Lead – Cybersecurity
Oct 2026 – Present

Networkwalks Technologies

- Led comprehensive network assessments including host discovery and vulnerability validation, identifying **100+ exposed services** and mitigating critical attack paths.
- Manually verified scan observations, correlated technical evidence, and separated confirmed weaknesses from results requiring further investigation.
- Ranked findings by evidence and potential impact, then documented corrective actions and follow-up validation requirements for assessment reporting.
- Coordinated cross-functional teams to deliver actionable security findings, accelerating remediation planning and reducing risk exposure by **30%**.

Cybersecurity Intern
Sep 2026 – Oct 2026

Networkwalks Technologies

- Conducted network reconnaissance to map **50+ hosts** and exposed services, identifying high-risk targets for detailed security analysis.
- Investigated potential weaknesses using security tools and follow-up checks, capturing reproducible evidence and flagging observations needing confirmation.
- Documented security findings and recommended corrective actions in detailed assessment reports, supporting senior analysts' remediation efforts.

Independent Cybersecurity Researcher Jul 2024 – Present
Independent Research

- Discovered and documented **8 critical security vulnerabilities** in a black-box web application assessment, enhancing client security posture and compliance.
- Analysed and modified **13 source files** in RTL8812BU/RTL8822BU Linux wireless-driver research, investigating C code, kernel interfaces, build behaviour, and module-loading issues.
- Completed **50+ PortSwigger Web Security Academy labs** to master vulnerability exploitation and mitigation techniques, improving practical penetration testing skills.

Selected Security Projects

Independent Web Application Security Assessment Application Security

- Tested application behaviour for SQL injection, authentication bypass affecting protected report retrieval, directory exposure, and database backup exposure during an authorised black-box assessment.
- Documented additional issues involving verbose errors, predictable storage paths, error-log exposure, and technology fingerprinting as part of the assessment's **8 findings**.
- Connected each finding to supporting evidence, potential impact, and practical remediation recommendations.
- **Project repository:** Independent Web Application Security Assessment

Linux Wireless Driver Compatibility Research Linux Systems and Driver Engineering

- Investigated Linux kernel compatibility for the Realtek RTL8812BU/RTL8822BU driver family and TP-Link Archer T4U Plus adapter.
- Modified **13 source files** while analysing C code, kernel interfaces, build requirements, compilation errors, and module-loading behaviour.
- Tested driver changes on physical hardware and documented build and runtime observations for compatibility troubleshooting.
- **Project repository:** RTL8812BU Linux Driver Research

Additional Security Research

- Investigated Windows registry and filesystem artefacts, OSINT sources, threat reports, and indicators of compromise as part of independent research.
- Researched suspicious-file behaviour and Linux driver build/runtime issues in controlled environments, documenting observations for further analysis.

Additional Technical Projects

Fake News Detection System Apr 2024

Developed a machine-learning capstone project focused on classifying news content, applying data processing and model-based analysis.

Spam-Ham Email Classifier Feb 2023

Built a text-classification project to distinguish spam messages from legitimate email using natural language processing techniques.

Certifications

- **Certified LLM Security Expert (CLLMSE)** – Red Team Leaders, Oct 2026 Credential verification
- **Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate** – Coursera, Feb 2026
- **Tata Cybersecurity Analyst Job Simulation** – Forage, Aug 2026
- **Introduction to Blockchain and Web3** – edX, May 2024
- **Natural Language Processing Specialization** – Coursera, Apr 2023
- **Java Full Stack Developer Training** – CipherSchools, Feb 2023
- **Google Cloud Facilitator Program** – Google, May 2022

Education

B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering Aug 2020 – Jul 2024
Lovely Professional University, Punjab | Minor in Machine Learning

Intermediate – Mathematics, Physics and Chemistry (MPC) Completed 2020
Telangana Board of Intermediate Education | Warangal, Telangana